

Getting Started With VWO SmartCode

In this article, we walk you through the basics of VWO SmartCode, what it is, why it is needed, and how to set it up on your website.

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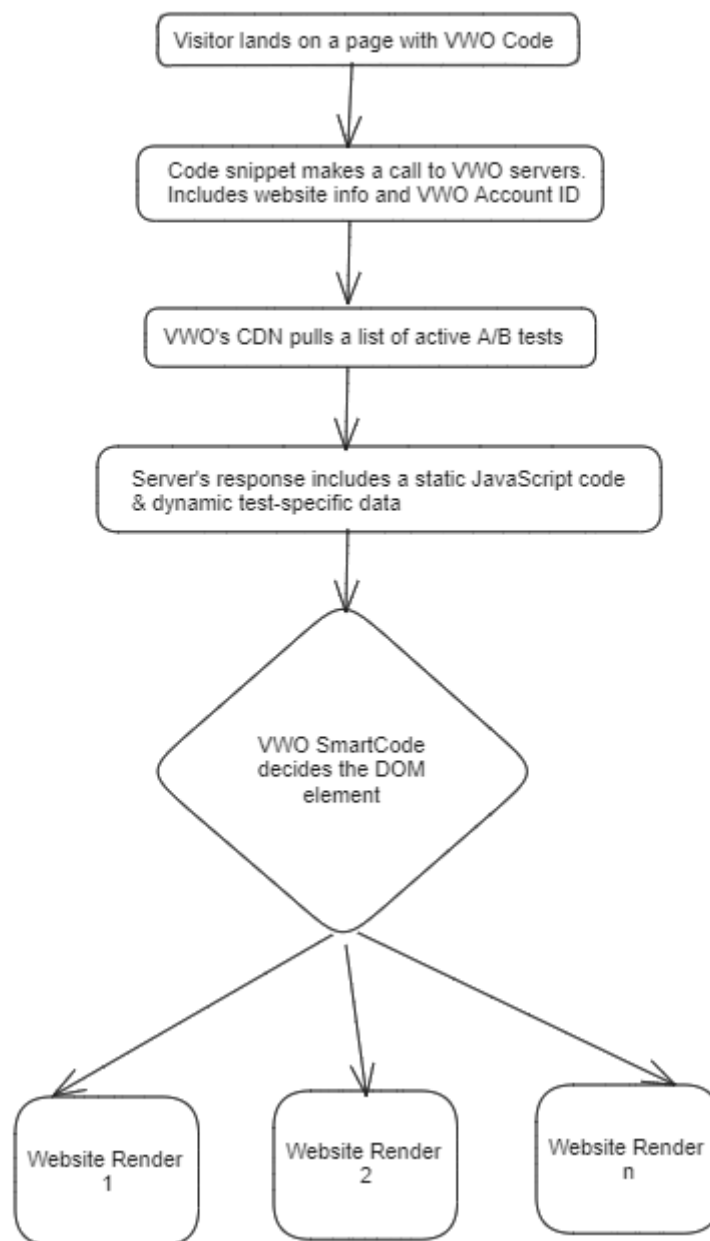
What is VWO SmartCode, and why is it needed?

Definition: The VWO SmartCode is a customized JavaScript code snippet that, when placed on your website's <head> section, allows your site to connect and interact with the VWO servers in real time.

The SmartCode serves as your website's gateway to the VWO Platform. It seamlessly captures user engagement data on your website and transmits it to the VWO platform. Utilizing this data, the platform optimizes your page to deliver a highly personalized and engaging web experience for each site visitor. Importantly, these interactions occur behind the scenes, with the adjustments made in seconds—unnoticeable to end users and invisible to search engine bots.

How does the VWO SmartCode work

Here's a quick overview of how the SmartCode works once it's added to your site's header:



Step 1: When a visitor lands on a page with the VWO code running, the code snippet pings the VWO servers. The SmartCode shares your website's information and unique VWO account ID with the VWO servers.

Step 2: VWO's CDN (Content Delivery Network) pulls up a list of all the active A/B tests relevant to this page. The server's response contains two critical parts:

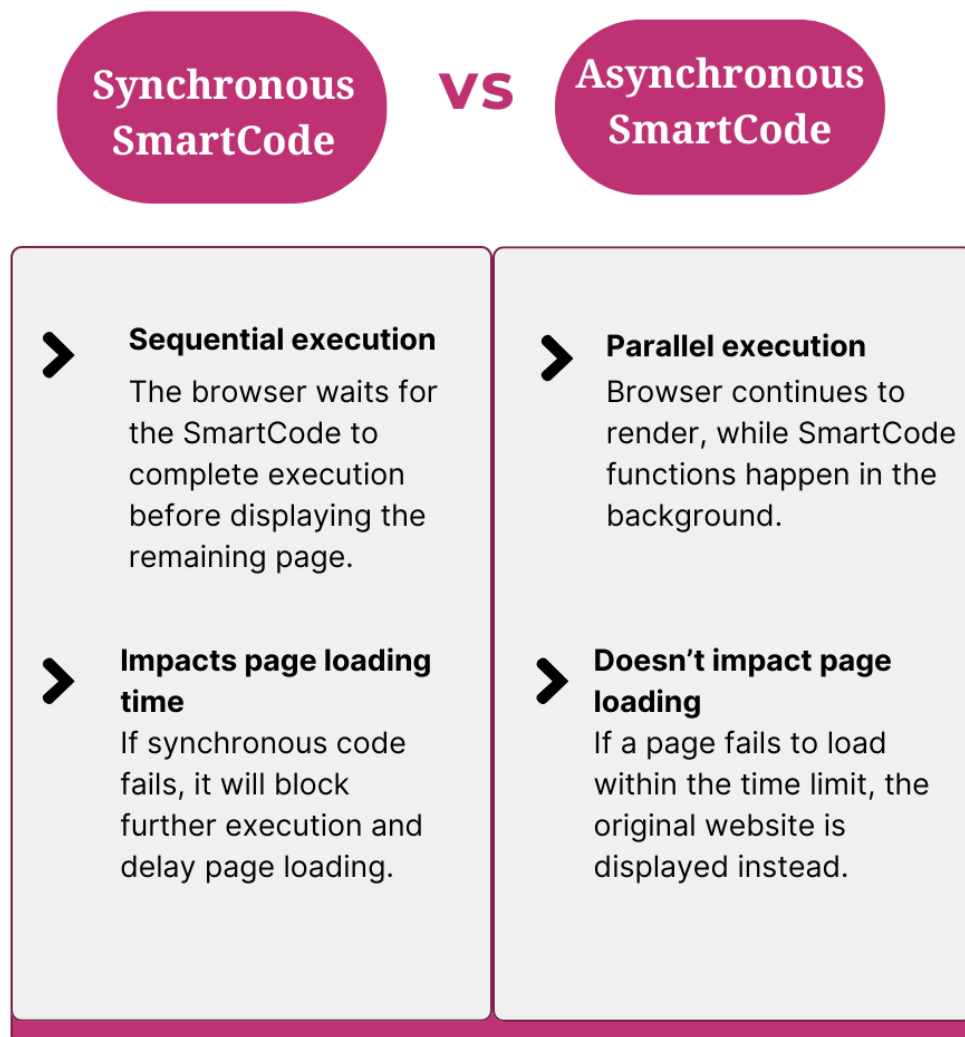
- A static JavaScript code to run the test
- Dynamic test-specific data

Note: VWO caches these responses on our servers to minimize the response time. Additionally, we use code minimization (minification) technologies and gzipping to reduce the response time further, thereby not impacting the site visitor's experience.

Step 3: The server's response instructs the VWO SmartCode to determine which DOM (Document Object Model) element to display.

Step 4: Depending on the server's response, the relevant version of the website is displayed. For example, the SmartCode might change the page layout, headline, etc., to make it more appealing and personalized for that specific visitor. All this happens in milliseconds and is unnoticeable to the site visitor.

Different types of VWO SmartCode



To learn more about each of the purposes and functions of these, refer to:

- [Synchronous VWO SmartCode](#)
- [Asynchronous VWO SmartCode](#)

Installation steps

Installing the VWO SmartCode snippet is easy and quick. Follow these steps to complete the installation:

1. Log into your VWO account and click the Settings  icon on the top right.
2. Navigate to the SmartCode tab on the Settings page.
3. Copy the asynchronous/synchronous code snippets as per your requirements.
4. Head to your website builder and place the code snippet anywhere between the following tags: `<head> VWO SmartCode snippet </head>`

Heads Up! You must add the code snippet to all pages on your website. If you use a template-based website builder with headers and footers, pasting the code snippet in the header section will replicate it across all pages.

Note: If you're using website builders like WordPress, Big Commerce, or Shopify, refer to this guide for detailed step-by-step instructions on [how to add the SmartCode snippet to your CRMs](#).

FAQs

1. Does the VWO SmartCode impact my site's SEO?

No. Search engine crawlers cannot read the SmartCode, so it doesn't impact your site's SEO ranking signals.

2. Can I use VWO SmartCode along with other analytics or tracking scripts like Google Analytics?

3. How does VWO SmartCode handle data privacy and security?

4. Is it GDPR compliant?

5. How often should I update the VWO SmartCode on my website?

6. Can I disable the VWO SmartCode temporarily without removing it?

7. How can I verify if the VWO SmartCode is working correctly?

8. How do I resolve issues during installation?

9. Can I customize the VWO SmartCode to target specific user segments?

10. Is the VWO SmartCode compatible with other JavaScript snippets in the <head>?

11. Can I use the VWO SmartCode for single-page applications?

12. Can I install the VWO SmartCode without developer assistance?